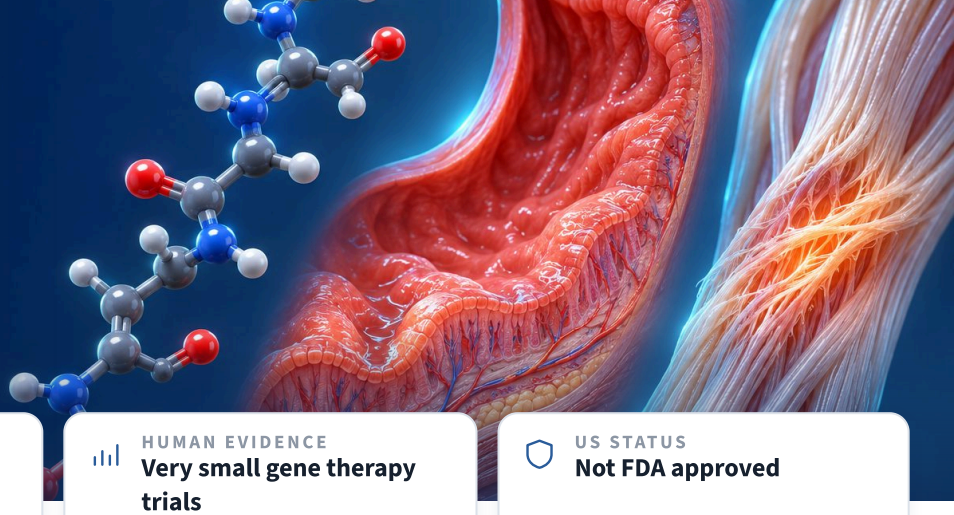
RECOVERY 06

Follistatin

Protein the body makes that binds myostatin and activin; tested in people only as gene therapy



CLASS Protein

STUDIED FOR Muscle disease, walking distance

HUMAN EVIDENCE Very small gene therapy trials

US STATUS Not FDA approved

STUDIED FOR

Muscle disease	Muscle size	FSH levels
HUMAN + ANIMAL	ANIMAL	HUMAN + ANIMAL

Given only as gene therapy. Published trials treated 12 people with muscle disease, without placebo groups. The protein itself has no published trial.

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Follistatin → Binds myostatin → Less growth limit → Muscle growth

- **Binds and blocks** myostatin, a signal that limits muscle growth, and activin
- **Can lower FSH** through the pituitary's activin–inhibin system
- **Gene delivery** (AAV or plasmid) makes the body produce the protein
- **Muscle gains** shown in monkeys; in people, data are from 12 patients

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

CASE REPORTS
LEVEL 2 OF 5

- 2 open-label trials, 12 patients
- No placebo-controlled trials
- Newer plasmid and AAV trials unpublished

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Long-term safety
- Effects on sperm or fertility
- Injected protein in people
- Effects in healthy men

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE Not established in people

ROUTES STUDIED Gene therapy injected into muscle (AAV or plasmid)

PHARMACOKINETICS Not established in people

SOLD AS Promoted online in compounded combo products (FDA)

MONITORED IN TRIALS 6-minute walk distance, muscle biopsies

SPORT (WADA) Prohibited, class S4

REGULATORY

FDA	Not approved, as a protein or gene therapy
WADA	Prohibited (S4.3; gene therapy also M3)

REFERENCES

1. Mol Ther, AAV1 follistatin gene therapy in Becker muscular dystrophy, Jan 2015
2. FDA, briefing document on KPV, PCAC meeting, May 2026
3. WADA, 2026 Prohibited List

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